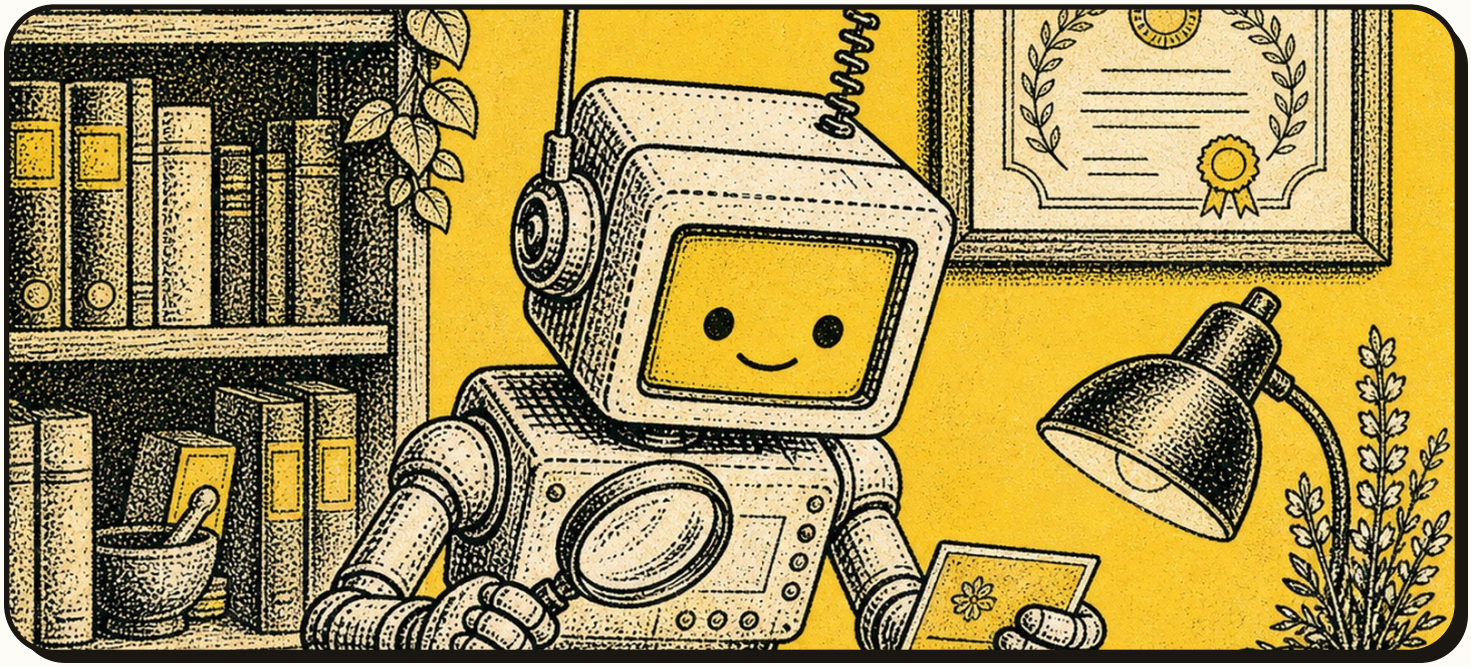
Good Websites

AUTHORITY CHECKLIST JULY 2026 / 10-POINT SELF-AUDIT

THE E-E-A-T + MEDICAL CONTENT TRUST CHECKLIST

A practical authority audit for naturopathic doctors



BUILD AUTHORITY ON PURPOSE.

Make qualifications verifiable, support health claims responsibly, and give patients clear factual information about the people and process behind every page.

10	CHECKS	5	FOCUS AREAS	1	ACTION PLAN

Make the practitioner unmistakable.

Authority starts with a real person whose role and professional standing are easy to understand.

1 Show the practitioner's full identity and role

WHY IT MATTERS

Patients should immediately know who is responsible for the care and content. Use a consistent professional name, designation, photograph, role, and practice affiliation.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Full name and ND designation are prominent
- [ ] A current professional photograph is present
- [ ] Role and areas of focus are described clearly
- [ ] Practice or clinic affiliation is consistent

QUICK TEST Can a visitor identify the responsible practitioner in five seconds?

2 Make professional credentials easy to verify

WHY IT MATTERS

List education, registration, associations, and relevant experience as precise, verifiable facts. Use the name shown on the CONO Register and avoid titles or wording that imply unrecognized specialist status.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Name matches the CONO Register
- [ ] ND title is used accurately
- [ ] Relevant associations are current
- [ ] Experience claims can be independently verified

QUICK TEST Could a cautious patient verify these credentials without guessing?

Name who created and reviewed the content.

Health information needs visible ownership, review responsibility, and honest dates.

3 Add clear bylines and reviewer credits

WHY IT MATTERS

Every substantial health article should identify its author. When clinical review adds value, name the reviewer and link both people to useful professional biographies.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Articles carry an accurate byline
- [ ] Clinical reviewers are credited where appropriate
- [ ] Names link to substantial author pages
- [ ] Author qualifications fit the subject

QUICK TEST Is it obvious who stands behind every health claim on the page?

4 Use created, reviewed, and updated dates honestly

WHY IT MATTERS

Dates should tell readers what actually happened. Do not change an updated date unless the content received a meaningful factual or editorial review.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Original publication date is available
- [ ] Clinical review date is shown when relevant
- [ ] Updated date reflects a real change
- [ ] Old or superseded advice is corrected

QUICK TEST Would the displayed date survive an editorial audit?

Support claims without overpromising.

Trust grows when evidence, limitations, and clinical language are handled carefully.

5 Cite credible sources close to important claims

WHY IT MATTERS

Use authoritative guidance, systematic reviews, primary research, and recognized professional sources where they are appropriate. Make it easy to connect a claim to its support.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Important claims have nearby citations
- [ ] Sources are authoritative for the topic
- [ ] Links reach the original source when possible
- [ ] Old evidence is reviewed for relevance

QUICK TEST Can a reader follow each important claim back to credible support?

6 Use responsible health and outcome language

WHY IT MATTERS

Explain possible benefits, limits, uncertainty, and individual variation. Avoid guarantees, universal promises, fear-based claims, or language that exceeds the supporting evidence.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Benefits are described without guarantees
- [ ] Limits and uncertainty are acknowledged
- [ ] Individual variation is made clear
- [ ] Claims follow applicable professional rules

QUICK TEST Would the wording still feel accurate to a skeptical clinician?

Add professional context that generic content cannot.

Useful content explains a qualified practitioner's reasoning and limitations, not just what other pages already say.

7 Explain who, how, and why behind the content

WHY IT MATTERS

Make the author, editorial process, and purpose understandable. If automation materially shaped the work, disclose its role when readers would reasonably expect that context.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The author and reviewer are identifiable
- [ ] The review process is described where useful
- [ ] The page has a clear patient-first purpose
- [ ] Material automation use is disclosed appropriately

QUICK TEST Can a reader understand who made this, how, and why?

8 Contribute original professional value

WHY IT MATTERS

Go beyond generic summaries with useful explanations, careful examples, original frameworks, practical decision points, or clearly attributed professional perspective.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The page adds more than a search summary
- [ ] Professional perspective is specific and useful
- [ ] Examples protect patient privacy
- [ ] The reader can take a safe next step

QUICK TEST Would someone bookmark this page even if search traffic disappeared?

Carry trust through the whole website.

Authority weakens when contact details, policies, or professional information conflict across pages.

9 Keep practice identity and policies consistent

WHY IT MATTERS

Use the same practice name, address, phone, practitioner details, and services across the website and key profiles. Make privacy, contact, and accessibility information easy to find.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Name, address, and phone stay consistent
- [ ] Practitioner bios agree across the site
- [ ] Privacy and contact pages are visible
- [ ] Fees and appointment expectations are current

QUICK TEST Does every page describe the same real-world practice?

10 Schedule a recurring trust and accuracy review

WHY IT MATTERS

Authority needs maintenance. Review high-impact health pages, credentials, sources, dates, policies, broken links, and professional claims on a documented schedule.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] High-impact pages have named owners
- [ ] A review schedule is documented
- [ ] Broken citations and links are repaired
- [ ] Material corrections are made promptly

QUICK TEST Who owns the next accuracy review, and when will it happen?

ADD UP YOUR SCORE.

Count the large checkbox on each item you can confidently tick today.

MY AUTHORITY SCORE

____ / 10

Fix one high-impact gap first.

0-3

Foundation missing

Resolve identity, access, accuracy, and essential trust gaps first.

4-6

Credible start

Choose the gaps with the greatest effect on patients and discovery.

7-9

Strong authority

Close the remaining gaps and make review part of normal operations.

10

Ready to compound

Maintain the standard, measure outcomes, and keep improving.

Your first improvement sprint

1. Highest-impact gap: _____

2. Owner + target date: _____

3. How success will be measured: _____

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GOODWEBSITES.CA

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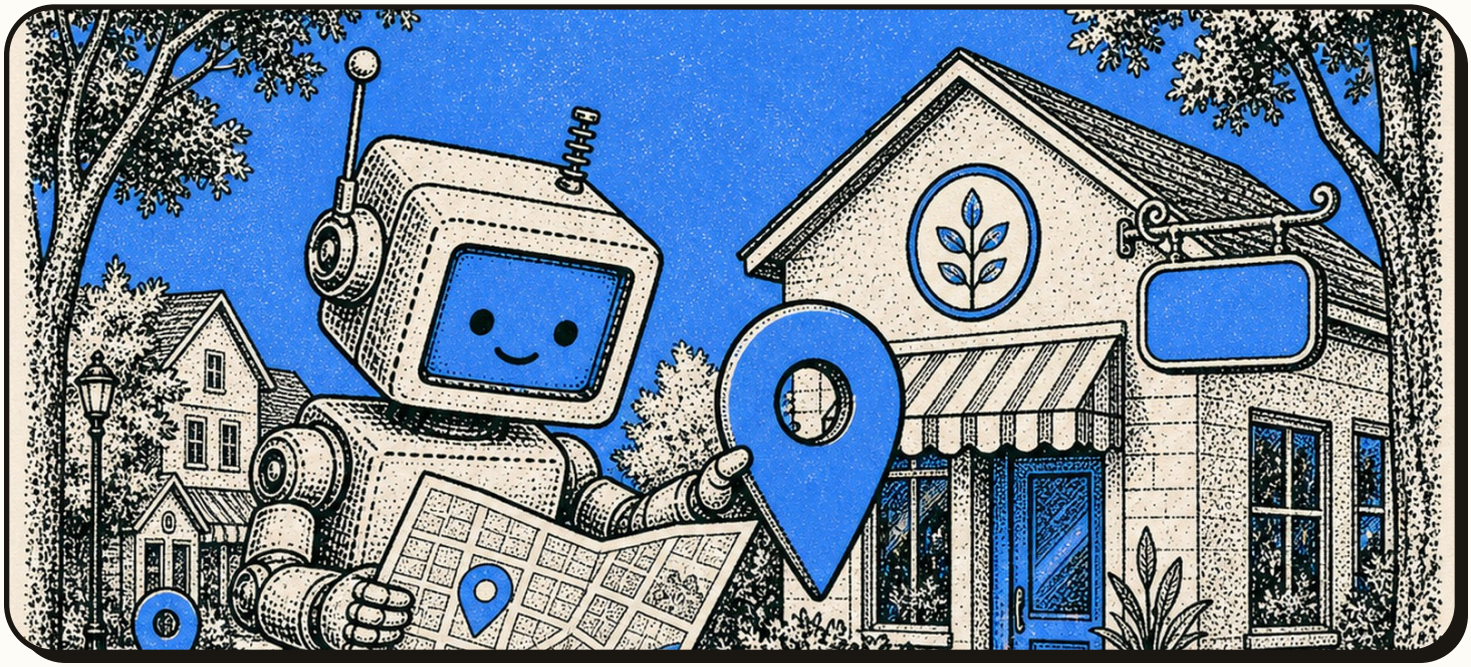
GUIDANCE USED CONO: Advertising guideline | CONO: Restricted titles | Google: People-first content

Good Websites

AUTHORITY CHECKLIST JULY 2026 / 10-POINT SELF-AUDIT

THE GOOGLE BUSINESS PROFILE + LOCAL SEO CHECKLIST

A local visibility audit for naturopathic practices



BUILD AUTHORITY ON PURPOSE.

Strengthen relevance, trust, and local prominence across Google Business Profile, your website, accurate listings, and the wider web while following Ontario advertising rules.

10	CHECKS	5	FOCUS AREAS	1	ACTION PLAN

Get the business identity right first.

A complete local profile begins with accurate ownership, naming, and categorization.

1 Claim, verify, and secure the correct profile

WHY IT MATTERS

Confirm that the practice is eligible, claim the right listing, complete verification, remove or resolve duplicates, and protect owner access with current account security.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The correct profile is claimed and verified
- [ ] Duplicate profiles are resolved
- [ ] Primary owners and managers are current
- [ ] Account recovery and security are documented

QUICK TEST Could the practice recover control of its profile today?

2 Use an accurate name and primary category

WHY IT MATTERS

Use the real-world business name without added keywords. Choose the most accurate primary category, then add only secondary categories that reflect services actually offered.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Business name matches real-world branding
- [ ] No keywords are added to the name
- [ ] Primary category describes the core business
- [ ] Secondary categories are accurate and limited

QUICK TEST Would a new patient immediately understand what this business is?

Complete every useful practice detail.

Accurate information helps Google match the profile and helps patients choose confidently.

3 Complete contact, hours, and booking information

WHY IT MATTERS

Keep the address or service area, phone, website, appointment link, regular hours, special hours, and accessibility details complete and current.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Address or service area is accurate
- [ ] Phone and website links work
- [ ] Appointment link opens the right booking flow
- [ ] Regular and special hours stay current

QUICK TEST Could a patient call, visit, or book without encountering stale information?

4 Describe services and useful profile attributes

WHY IT MATTERS

Add the services patients actually search for, with clear and compliant descriptions. Complete relevant attributes without stretching categories or making unsupported claims.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Core services are listed individually
- [ ] Descriptions use patient-friendly language
- [ ] Relevant attributes are completed
- [ ] Services match what the website offers

QUICK TEST Does the profile fully explain what someone can book?

Show a real, active practice.

Authentic imagery and compliant profile stewardship make the listing more useful without relying on testimonials.

5 Publish authentic photos and videos

WHY IT MATTERS

Use current images of the exterior, entrance, reception, treatment environment, practitioners, and accessibility features. Avoid stock imagery that could misrepresent the location.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Exterior and entrance are recognizable
- [ ] Interior photos reflect the current space
- [ ] Practitioner images are professional and current
- [ ] Accessibility features are visible where relevant

QUICK TEST Would a first-time visitor recognize the clinic when they arrive?

6 Do not solicit or promote patient reviews

WHY IT MATTERS

CONO treats public patient reviews as testimonials. Do not ask patients to post them, use review badges or widgets, reproduce review text, or direct visitors to review content.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] No review requests are sent
- [ ] No review badge or widget is displayed
- [ ] No patient review text is reused
- [ ] Staff understand the restriction

QUICK TEST Could any part of the process encourage or promote a patient testimonial?

Connect the profile to a strong local website.

Local visibility improves when the profile, website, directories, and real-world practice agree.

7 Manage unsolicited reviews under CONO guidance

WHY IT MATTERS

Where a platform will not disable reviews, document reasonable attempts to request removal. Do not amplify the review, confirm a clinical relationship, discuss care, or use the content elsewhere.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Removal requests are documented
- [ ] No clinical relationship is confirmed
- [ ] Review content is not republished
- [ ] Privacy and escalation steps are clear

QUICK TEST Can the practice show reasonable steps without amplifying the testimonial?

8 Match the website and profile details

WHY IT MATTERS

Point the profile to the most useful local page and keep the business name, address, phone, hours, services, booking destination, and practitioner details aligned.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Profile links to the best local landing page
- [ ] Name, address, and phone match
- [ ] Hours and services agree
- [ ] LocalBusiness data reflects visible information

QUICK TEST Would Google and a patient see one consistent business entity?

Build local recognition and monitor it.

Relevant links, accurate citations, current information, and ongoing measurement strengthen local prominence.

9 Strengthen legitimate local prominence

WHY IT MATTERS

Earn accurate listings and relevant mentions from professional associations, local organizations, trusted directories, community partners, and useful editorial coverage.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Key professional listings are accurate
- [ ] Local directories use consistent details
- [ ] Relevant organizations link to the site
- [ ] Inauthentic mentions are avoided

QUICK TEST Do trusted local sources confirm this practice exists and matters?

10 Review profile performance every month

WHY IT MATTERS

Track searches, views, calls, website visits, booking actions, photo freshness, profile edits, unsolicited public content, and policy alerts. Assign ownership before problems become urgent.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Profile performance is reviewed monthly
- [ ] Booking and website actions are tracked
- [ ] New edits and alerts are checked
- [ ] One person owns ongoing maintenance

QUICK TEST Can you explain which profile actions lead to appointments?

ADD UP YOUR SCORE.

Count the large checkbox on each item you can confidently tick today.

MY AUTHORITY SCORE

____ / 10

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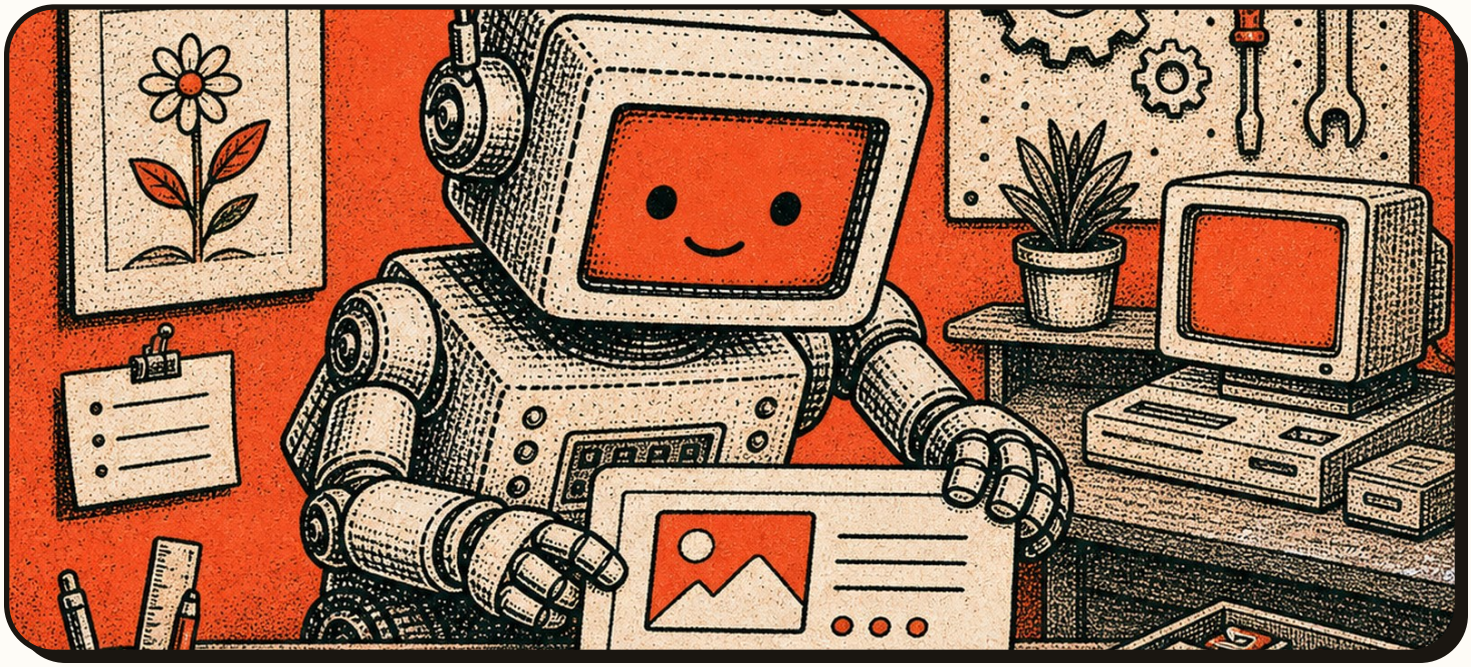
GUIDANCE USED CONO: Online reviews | CONO: Advertising guideline | Google: Improve local ranking

Good Websites

AUTHORITY CHECKLIST JULY 2026 / 10-POINT SELF-AUDIT

THE SERVICE PAGE SEO + AEO CHECKLIST

A patient-first landing page audit for clinics



BUILD AUTHORITY ON PURPOSE.

Build focused service pages that answer real questions, show verifiable qualifications, support discovery, and make the next step clear.

10	CHECKS	5	FOCUS AREAS	1	ACTION PLAN

Give each page one clear job.

Strong service pages begin with a real patient need and a distinct purpose in the site architecture.

1 Choose one meaningful patient intent

WHY IT MATTERS

Build the page around one service or closely related need that the practice genuinely addresses. Avoid splitting near-identical keyword variations into thin duplicate pages.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] One primary patient need anchors the page
- [ ] The service is actually offered
- [ ] Intent differs from other service pages
- [ ] Keyword variants are not turned into duplicates

QUICK TEST Can the purpose of this page be stated in one sentence?

2 Write a unique title, H1, and search summary

WHY IT MATTERS

Use a concise title and H1 that accurately describe the service. Include location only when it is useful and truthful, then write a compelling human-readable summary.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Title is unique, concise, and accurate
- [ ] H1 clearly names the page topic
- [ ] Location appears only where useful
- [ ] Meta description supports a useful click decision

QUICK TEST Would the search result accurately set expectations for the page?

Answer the important questions early.

Patients and search systems should understand the service before working through every detail.

3 Explain what it is, who it is for, and what happens

WHY IT MATTERS

Open with a plain-language explanation of the service, the people it may suit, what an appointment involves, and the appropriate next step.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The service is defined in plain language
- [ ] The intended patient or need is clear
- [ ] The appointment process is summarized
- [ ] A sensible next step appears early

QUICK TEST Can a patient understand the offer without decoding clinical jargon?

4 Cover the full decision journey

WHY IT MATTERS

Answer the questions people need before booking: approach, practitioner, visit format, fees, timing, location, limitations, preparation, and what follows the first appointment.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Approach and visit format are explained
- [ ] Practitioner and credentials are visible
- [ ] Fees, timing, and location are clear
- [ ] Limitations and expectations are addressed

QUICK TEST What important booking question would still force a phone call?

Show qualifications responsibly.

The page should be useful and informative without making unsupported health promises.

5 Add practitioner qualifications and credible support

WHY IT MATTERS

Connect the service to a real practitioner with relevant credentials, experience, and professional perspective. Cite authoritative sources for important health claims.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] A qualified practitioner is identified
- [ ] Relevant credentials link to a useful bio
- [ ] Important claims have credible support
- [ ] Original professional context is present

QUICK TEST Can a reader verify who is responsible and why the information is credible?

6 Use accurate, compliant outcome language

WHY IT MATTERS

Avoid testimonials, review promotion, guarantees, exaggerated certainty, fear, superlatives, or titles implying specialization. Explain uncertainty, individual variation, referral boundaries, and what the service does not promise.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] No guaranteed outcomes are promised
- [ ] Individual variation is acknowledged
- [ ] No testimonial or specialty claim appears
- [ ] The page avoids diagnosing the reader

QUICK TEST Is the page persuasive without overstating what care can achieve?

Make the page easy to crawl and understand.

Clear text, headings, internal links, and accurate metadata support both SEO and AI-powered discovery.

7 Use clear headings and accessible textual content

WHY IT MATTERS

Organize the page around meaningful questions and sections. Keep important information in readable HTML text rather than hiding it in images, tabs, or scripts that fail to render.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Headings describe the content below
- [ ] Important answers exist as HTML text
- [ ] Lists and paragraphs are easy to scan
- [ ] Images have useful alternative text

QUICK TEST Could a reader or crawler outline the page from its headings?

8 Connect the page through useful internal links

WHY IT MATTERS

Link from navigation, related services, practitioner bios, location pages, and relevant articles. Use descriptive anchors and give readers a logical path in both directions.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The page is reachable through crawlable links
- [ ] Related pages link to it contextually
- [ ] Anchor text describes the destination
- [ ] The page links onward to useful next content

QUICK TEST Can a patient reach this page without relying on site search?

Make it work, measure it, improve it.

A discoverable page still needs a fast experience, an honest next step, and performance feedback.

9 Validate mobile experience and relevant markup

WHY IT MATTERS

Test speed, stability, forms, and readability on mobile. Add only structured data that applies, matches visible content, and follows the specific search feature guidelines.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Mobile loading and layout are reliable
- [ ] Forms and booking links work
- [ ] Markup matches visible page content
- [ ] Rich Results Test shows no critical errors

QUICK TEST Does the page remain fast, clear, and truthful on a phone?

10 Use a clear booking action and track it

WHY IT MATTERS

Offer a direct, specific next step at useful points on the page. Measure booking clicks or completions, search queries, engagement, and changes after meaningful updates.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Primary CTA states what happens next
- [ ] Booking opens the correct destination
- [ ] Conversion actions are measured
- [ ] Search and page performance are reviewed

QUICK TEST Can you tell whether this page creates qualified booking activity?

ADD UP YOUR SCORE.

Count the large checkbox on each item you can confidently tick today.

MY AUTHORITY SCORE

____ / 10

Fix one high-impact gap first.

0-3

Foundation missing

Resolve identity, access, accuracy, and essential trust gaps first.

4-6

Credible start

Choose the gaps with the greatest effect on patients and discovery.

7-9

Strong authority

Close the remaining gaps and make review part of normal operations.

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Ready to compound

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Your first improvement sprint

1. Highest-impact gap: _____

2. Owner + target date: _____

3. How success will be measured: _____

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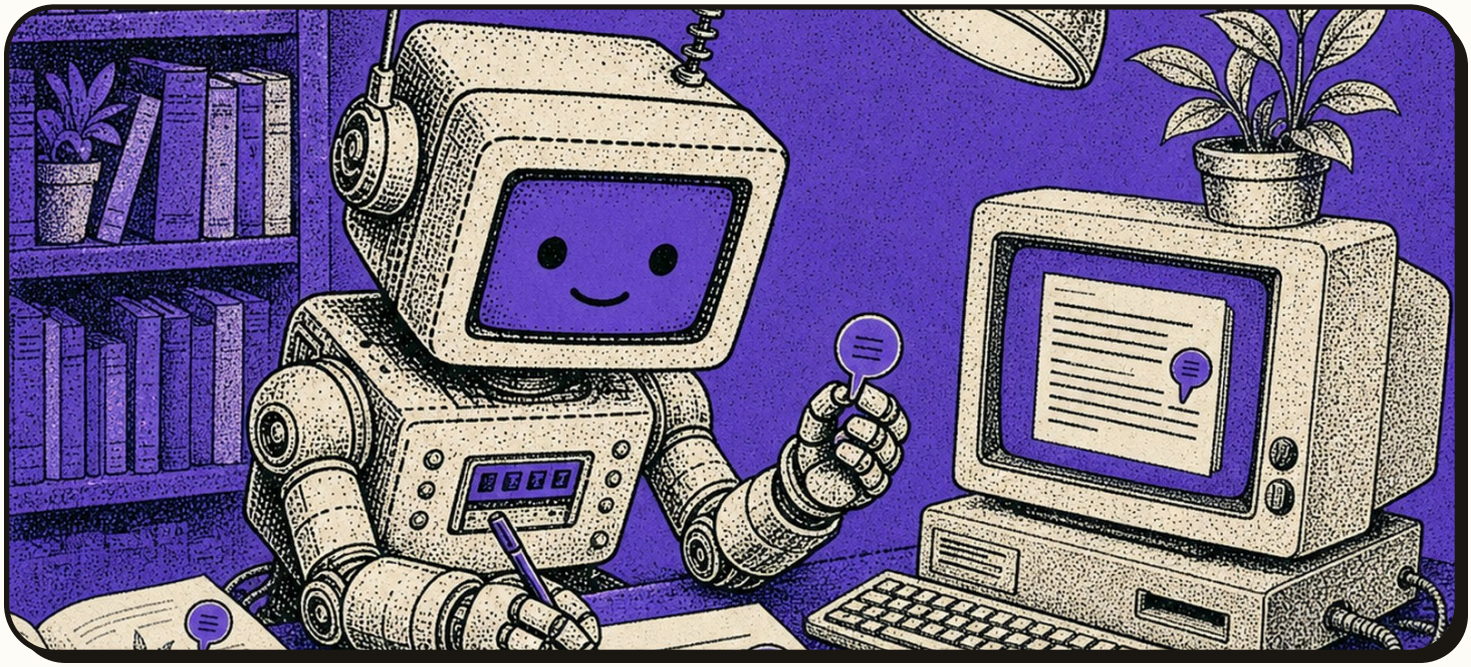
GUIDANCE USED CONO: Advertising guideline | Google: SEO Starter Guide | Google: AI optimization guide

Good Websites

AUTHORITY CHECKLIST JULY 2026 / 10-POINT SELF-AUDIT

THE AI-CITATION-READY ARTICLE CHECKLIST

An evidence-led publishing audit for health content



BUILD AUTHORITY ON PURPOSE.

Create original, practitioner-led articles that answer real questions, support important claims, stay indexable, and give search systems credible material to reference.

10	CHECKS	5	FOCUS AREAS	1	ACTION PLAN

Start with a question worth answering.

Citation-worthy articles solve a real information need instead of chasing every keyword variation.

1 Choose one real patient question and purpose

WHY IT MATTERS

Define the audience, the decision or problem, and what a satisfying answer should help them understand. Keep the article aligned with the practitioner's verifiable qualifications, scope, and competence.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] One clear question anchors the article
- [ ] The intended reader is defined
- [ ] The topic fits the author's qualifications
- [ ] The article has a useful patient-first purpose

QUICK TEST Would the intended reader seek this answer even without search engines?

2 Give a concise answer before the deep explanation

WHY IT MATTERS

State the useful answer early, then add context, evidence, nuance, limitations, and next steps. Avoid forcing readers through a long introduction before addressing the question.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] A direct answer appears near the beginning
- [ ] Important caveats appear with the answer
- [ ] The opening matches the article title
- [ ] The rest of the article expands usefully

QUICK TEST Can the core answer be understood from the opening section?

Put a qualified practitioner behind the answer.

Clear authorship and original professional value help distinguish useful content from commodity summaries.

3 Assign a qualified author and reviewer

WHY IT MATTERS

Name the author, connect the byline to a detailed biography, and add an appropriate clinical reviewer when the topic benefits from additional oversight.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The author is named clearly
- [ ] Author qualifications match the topic
- [ ] Reviewer is credited where appropriate
- [ ] Bylines link to substantial biographies

QUICK TEST Can a reader verify why these people are qualified to answer?

4 Contribute non-commodity professional value

WHY IT MATTERS

Add original explanations, frameworks, decision points, careful examples, or professional perspective. Do not merely rewrite the current search results in different words.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] The article contributes original value
- [ ] Professional insight is specific, not decorative
- [ ] Examples are useful and privacy-safe
- [ ] The article goes beyond common summaries

QUICK TEST What would another page need to cite this article for?

Make important claims traceable.

Evidence is most useful when readers can see which source supports which statement.

5 Use authoritative and primary sources

WHY IT MATTERS

Prefer current guidelines, systematic reviews, primary studies, government or institutional sources, and recognized professional bodies as appropriate for the claim.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Sources are authoritative for the subject
- [ ] Primary sources are used when practical
- [ ] Evidence is current enough for the claim
- [ ] Source quality is considered, not just quantity

QUICK TEST Would these sources satisfy a careful reader checking the claim?

6 Place citations beside the claims they support

WHY IT MATTERS

Use descriptive links or reference markers close to the relevant sentence. Avoid dumping an unexplained bibliography at the end or linking to secondary summaries unnecessarily.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Citations sit close to supported claims
- [ ] Links use meaningful descriptions
- [ ] Readers can reach the original source
- [ ] Sources are not misrepresented

QUICK TEST Can every important factual claim be traced without detective work?

Organize for readers, not AEO folklore.

Good headings, readable text, and useful depth matter; forced micro-chunks and AI-only rewrites do not.

7 Use descriptive headings and natural answer sections

WHY IT MATTERS

Let headings reflect the real questions and decisions in the topic. Use the length each section needs rather than splitting content into tiny artificial chunks.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Headings accurately describe each section
- [ ] Questions reflect real reader needs
- [ ] Sections are complete without filler
- [ ] No artificial chunking is used for AI

QUICK TEST Does the structure improve understanding for a human reader?

8 Keep important information textual and accessible

WHY IT MATTERS

Publish essential facts in readable HTML text. Use relevant images, diagrams, tables, captions, and alternative text to support the answer without hiding it inside media.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Core answers are available as HTML text
- [ ] Images add meaningful information
- [ ] Alternative text is useful and concise
- [ ] Tables and embeds work on mobile

QUICK TEST Would the article remain useful if the images failed to load?

Stay indexable, current, and measurable.

AI visibility still depends on foundational search eligibility and continued editorial maintenance.

9 Confirm search and snippet eligibility

WHY IT MATTERS

Make sure the page is public, crawlable, indexable, internally linked, canonical, and eligible to show a search snippet. Use only accurate structured data that matches visible content.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Googlebot can access a working page
- [ ] No accidental noindex or snippet block exists
- [ ] Canonical and internal links are correct
- [ ] Structured data matches visible content

QUICK TEST Can Search Console confirm the preferred page is eligible to appear?

10 Review accuracy, AI use, and performance

WHY IT MATTERS

Disclose material automation use when appropriate, avoid scaled low-value publishing, review factual accuracy and Ontario advertising compliance, and monitor search visibility and useful actions.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Material automation use is disclosed where useful
- [ ] Human review protects accuracy and originality
- [ ] Ontario advertising rules are checked
- [ ] Search and useful actions are monitored

QUICK TEST Is this article improving through evidence rather than publishing volume?

ADD UP YOUR SCORE.

Count the large checkbox on each item you can confidently tick today.

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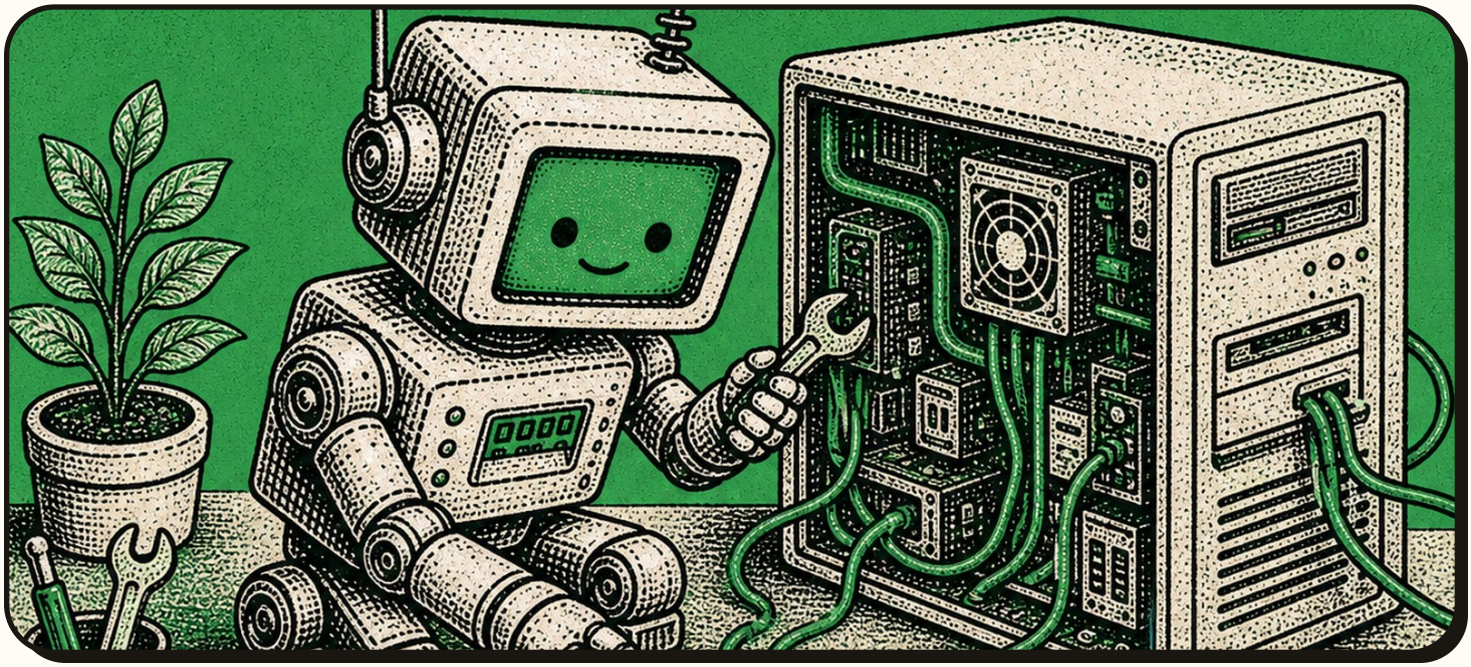
GUIDANCE USED CONO: Advertising guideline | Google: AI optimization guide | Google: People-first content

Good Websites

AUTHORITY CHECKLIST JULY 2026 / 10-POINT SELF-AUDIT

THE TECHNICAL SEO + INDEXABILITY CHECKLIST

A crawl, rendering, and validation audit for clinics



BUILD AUTHORITY ON PURPOSE.

Remove the technical barriers that prevent useful pages from being discovered, crawled, indexed, understood, and measured.

10	CHECKS	5	FOCUS AREAS	1	ACTION PLAN

Make every intended page reachable.

Search eligibility starts with public access, successful responses, and indexable content.

1 Serve public indexable pages with a 200 status

WHY IT MATTERS

Every page intended for search should be publicly accessible, return a successful HTTP response, and contain meaningful indexable content rather than an error, login, or empty shell.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Preferred URLs return HTTP 200
- [ ] No login or consent wall blocks content
- [ ] Soft 404 and empty pages are identified
- [ ] Main text is present in the rendered page

QUICK TEST Does URL Inspection see the same useful page a visitor sees?

2 Allow the required crawlers through every layer

WHY IT MATTERS

Check robots.txt, CDN settings, firewalls, bot protection, hosting rules, and staging controls. A page cannot be evaluated if the crawler cannot reliably reach it.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Robots.txt allows intended content
- [ ] CDN and firewall do not block Googlebot
- [ ] Staging restrictions are absent in production
- [ ] Critical CSS, scripts, and images are crawlable

QUICK TEST Could infrastructure block a crawler even when robots.txt looks correct?

Tell search engines which URLs belong.

Indexing directives, canonicals, and redirects should express one coherent URL strategy.

3 Audit robots meta and snippet controls

WHY IT MATTERS

Use index, noindex, nosnippet, and related controls intentionally. Remember that crawlers must access a page before they can read its page-level directives.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Indexable pages have no accidental noindex
- [ ] Noindex pages remain crawlable when needed
- [ ] Snippet limits are intentional
- [ ] HTTP and HTML directives do not conflict

QUICK TEST Can you explain why every excluded page is excluded?

4 Use canonicals and redirects consistently

WHY IT MATTERS

Choose one preferred URL for duplicate or near-duplicate content. Align canonical tags, redirects, internal links, sitemaps, protocol, hostname, and trailing-slash behaviour.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Each indexable page has a sensible canonical
- [ ] Redirect chains and loops are removed
- [ ] Internal links point to preferred URLs
- [ ] Canonical and sitemap signals agree

QUICK TEST Do all technical signals nominate the same preferred URL?

Build discoverable paths through the site.

Sitemaps help discovery, but crawlable internal links explain hierarchy and importance.

5 Maintain a clean XML sitemap

WHY IT MATTERS

Include only canonical, indexable, successful URLs that matter. Keep last-modified data honest, submit the sitemap in Search Console, and monitor processing errors.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Only preferred indexable URLs are included
- [ ] All sitemap URLs return HTTP 200
- [ ] Last-modified values reflect real changes
- [ ] Sitemap status is monitored in Search Console

QUICK TEST Would every URL in the sitemap deserve to appear in search?

6 Use crawlable and descriptive internal links

WHY IT MATTERS

Link important pages using standard anchor elements and useful anchor text. Eliminate orphan pages and create logical routes between services, practitioners, locations, and articles.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Important pages receive crawlable links
- [ ] Anchor text describes the destination
- [ ] Orphan pages are found and resolved
- [ ] Site hierarchy is understandable from links

QUICK TEST Can a crawler reach every priority page without using the sitemap?

Deliver the important content reliably.

Rendering, mobile experience, and accessible structure determine whether pages work in practice.

7 Keep essential content in the rendered HTML

WHY IT MATTERS

Make sure headings, body copy, links, practitioner details, and calls to action appear in the rendered DOM. Do not rely on images or fragile scripts for critical information.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Main text appears in the rendered DOM
- [ ] Navigation links render as real links
- [ ] Lazy loading does not hide critical content
- [ ] Important information is not image-only

QUICK TEST Does the rendered page preserve every fact needed for search and booking?

8 Validate mobile performance and page stability

WHY IT MATTERS

Test real mobile loading, responsiveness, visual stability, HTTPS, forms, keyboard access, and readable layouts. Fix failures that prevent patients from using the page.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Core content loads promptly on mobile
- [ ] Layout does not jump during loading
- [ ] HTTPS and forms work without errors
- [ ] Keyboard and readable layout checks pass

QUICK TEST Can a patient complete the key task on a slow mobile connection?

Test what search engines actually receive.

Search Console and validation tools turn technical assumptions into observable evidence.

9 Validate structured data against visible content

WHY IT MATTERS

Use supported, relevant types and complete properties. Ensure markup describes what users can actually see, then test it before and after deployment.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Markup uses applicable supported types
- [ ] Structured data matches visible content
- [ ] Rich Results Test has no critical errors
- [ ] Deployed pages are monitored for breakage

QUICK TEST Could any markup be interpreted as incomplete, hidden, or misleading?

10 Monitor indexing, crawling, and changes

WHY IT MATTERS

Use Page Indexing, Crawl Stats, URL Inspection, sitemap reports, performance data, and release notes to catch regressions. Assign owners and document the fix history.

CHECK FOR

- [ ] Page Indexing issues are reviewed
- [ ] Crawl Stats anomalies are investigated
- [ ] Priority URLs are tested after releases
- [ ] Technical fixes have owners and dates

QUICK TEST How quickly would the team notice an accidental site-wide noindex?

ADD UP YOUR SCORE.

Count the large checkbox on each item you can confidently tick today.

MY AUTHORITY SCORE

____ / 10

Fix one high-impact gap first.

0-3

Foundation missing

Resolve identity, access, accuracy, and essential trust gaps first.

4-6

Credible start

Choose the gaps with the greatest effect on patients and discovery.

7-9

Strong authority

Close the remaining gaps and make review part of normal operations.

10

Ready to compound

Maintain the standard, measure outcomes, and keep improving.

Your first improvement sprint

1. Highest-impact gap: _____

2. Owner + target date: _____

3. How success will be measured: _____

Want a second set of eyes?

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MEMBER NOTE: Educational only - not CONO approval or legal advice; registrants remain responsible for current standards, scope, and advertising.

GUIDANCE USED Google: Technical requirements | Google: Sitemaps overview | Google: Robots meta specifications